

Ultimate Werewolf Deluxe Edition

Ultimate Werewolf by Bezier games is a party card game for up to 75 players, which can get a bit chaotic. This is a variant of the Mafia game, with more specialised roles being handed out to people. The setting is a medieval village, with the teams being divided into two basic categories – werewolves and the villagers. The villagers have to try and kill all the werewolves, while the werewolves try to survive, and take out the villagers one by one. During the day phase, everyone votes to eliminate or lynch one player. During the night phase, everyone goes to “sleep” by closing their eyes, and the werewolves wake up and decide to kill one person in secret. There are additional unique roles, such as a seer, a witch, the troublemaker, or the bodyguard. Players with these roles get to perform day or night time actions and are on different teams. The seer, for example, can learn the role of a particular player once every night. The priest has immunity from being killed by



the villagers, but can be killed by werewolves. There are 40 unique roles in the Deluxe Edition. The moderator also has to build the deck for every game, which involves choosing the cards that the people play with. There are plus and minus indicators on the role cards, and a balanced game should

ideally sum up to zero. There are some roles that are on a team of their own – such as the Tanner and Nostradamus. The Tanner wins if he is killed, which involves convincing the villagers that he is a werewolf, or convincing the werewolves to kill him. Nostradamus wins if he is alive at the end of the game, and predicts which team would win. The game keeps progressing through days and nights till either all the villagers or all the werewolves are dead.

Ultimate Werewolf (UW) is not the same as One Night Ultimate Werewolf (ONUW), which is a totally different game and comes with additional tokens. Instead of multiple nights, the gameplay takes place over the course of a single night. This version is a faster, quicker, and more fun variant of the game. As the UW box has three extra blank cards, it is possible to play ONUW using these extra cards. For example, the Robber card is available in ONUW, but not in UW. The actions of the associated roles are also different between the games. These cards can also be used by the moderator to make up new roles and actions. The Deluxe Edition comes with different sets of additional cards, which is one expansion pack. You will have to check which additional pack you are getting with a particular Deluxe Edition.

This is a fun party game that sparks interesting discussions long after the game itself is finished, as everyone tries to figure out what went wrong.

PRICE: ₹2,139/-

Miko 2

Mumbai-based robotics startup Emotix launched its Miko 2 companion robot last year. We got our hands on it this month, to test its features and performance at, well, being a companion to a child.

Miko 2 features advanced parental controls, better microphones, a front camera, and improved “emotional intelligence”, according to Emotix.

Our experience was a mixed bag. For starters, there were some issues connecting to the local Wi-Fi which took a while to resolve by switching to a mobile hotspot. Once that was done, Miko 2 was ready to answer questions after using the ‘Hello Miko’ keyword. It senses the direction of the speaker and turns to face them, and does so quite well. However, the voice detection is far from perfect and so is how it is processed. In many instances, it failed to detect the trigger phrase or detected it much later than it was spoken.

The telepresence feature works quite well in close range but drops connectivity and quality quite a lot as the distance increases. The obstacle detection works well but the edge detection does not, as we were able to make it topple off the edge of the table in the telepresence mode. The content on the device is also somewhat lacking. Except for the onboard Knowledge Hub and the quiz game, all other apps merely play non-interactive videos, which are educational but far from engaging. The Knowledge Hub and Quiz app provide interesting ways for a child to learn new things about the world around them. It could use more voice-activated features in these apps as well.

The device is a very interesting proposition, but in its current state, considering its 25k price, it could do with some improvements. The Miko 3, if there ever is one, ought to be pretty exciting.

Price: ₹24,999/-

